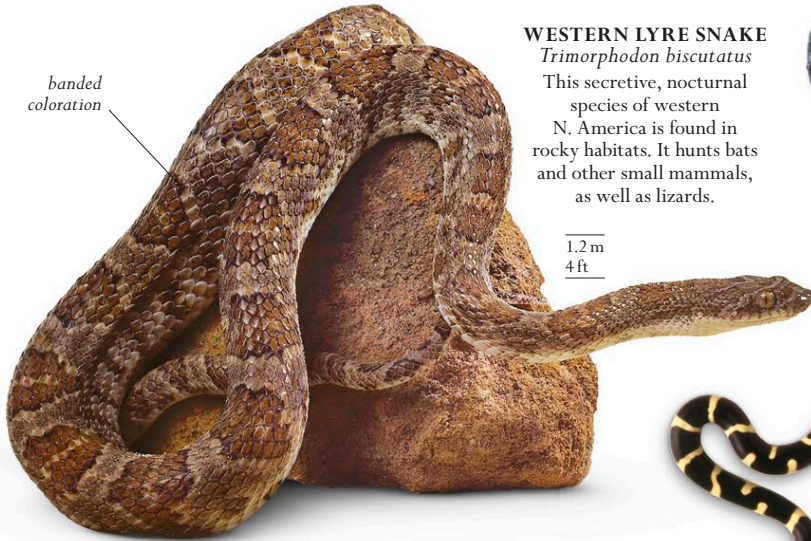


COLUBRIDS

With around 2,000 species worldwide, colubrids form the largest family of snakes. The members of the family Colubridae inhabit a wide range of habitats, from deserts to wetlands. They have a varied diet. Many species lay eggs.



WESTERN LYRE SNAKE

Trimorphodon biscutatus

This secretive, nocturnal species of western N. America is found in rocky habitats. It hunts bats and other small mammals, as well as lizards.

1.2 m
4 ft



1.3 m
4 1/4 ft

COMMON GARTER SNAKE

Thamnophis sirtalis

This N. American species is active during daytime, hunting vertebrates in a range of habitats. In Manitoba, after hibernation it congregates in large numbers to mate.



large eye

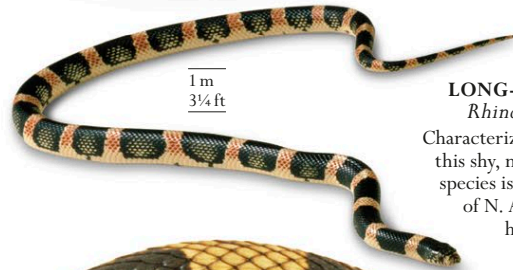
46 cm
18 in



GREY EARTHSNAKE

Geophis brachycephalus

This small, C. American snake is terrestrial and nocturnal. It feeds mainly on earthworms and soft insect larvae.



1 m
3 1/4 ft

LONG-NOSED SNAKE

Rhinocheilus lecontei

Characterized by a pointed snout, this shy, nocturnal, burrowing species is from dry grasslands of N. America, where it hunts lizards.

RUTHVEN'S KINGSNAKE

Lampropeltis ruthveni

An egg-laying species, this colubrid is from the Mexican plateau, where it hunts rodents and lizards in dry woodland.

90 cm
35 in



1.1 m
3 1/2 ft

CALIFORNIA MOUNTAIN KINGSNAKE

Lampropeltis zonata

This secretive snake prefers high-altitude wooded habitats. It is typically nocturnal, but is diurnal when nights are cold.



1.2 m
4 ft

AFRICAN EGG-EATING SNAKE

Dasypeltis scabra

This African snake has a highly specialized diet of eggs on which it feasts during the bird-nesting season. It then fasts for the rest of the year.



blotched, brown coloration

long, powerful body

2.8 m
9 1/4 ft

PINE SNAKE

Pituophis melanoleucus

When threatened, this large, powerful snake of woodlands in N. America ejects foul-smelling waste from its rear opening (cloaca).